ISFT
INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF FINANCIAL TRAINING

OCN London BESPOKE

BESPOKE QUALIFICATION

# ISFT Award in Introduction to Behavioural Psychology in Trading

*The market moves on numbers. You move on emotion.*

| 4 | 8 | Level 3 | Online |
|---|---|---|---|
| UNITS | CREDITS | AWARD | SELF-PACED |

www.derivion.in · Centre: Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT) · Course code 1131238

# Every trading system fails the same way: at the moment someone panics.

Technical skill gets you a plan. This qualification is about what happens to that plan under pressure — and how to keep it intact.



### Practitioner-designed

Authored by the centre's Head Educator, informed by direct experience of the psychological demands of professional trading over four decades.



### Grounded in behavioural finance

Cognitive bias, herd behaviour and the psychology behind market bubbles and crashes — not just trader mindset.



### Standardised and accredited

Delivered under OCN London (course code 1131238), with a defined credit value, level and external quality assurance.



### Applied, not just informational

Learners keep a structured reflective journal, evaluating their own emotional responses and trading behaviour.

# For traders who already know the market — and want to understand themselves in it.

Designed for traders and finance professionals who have technical market knowledge but wish to address the emotional and behavioural factors that influence trading performance.

### Technically skilled traders

Have the market knowledge; want the discipline to match.

### Self-aware professionals

Curious about the biases behind their own decisions.

### Level 2 completers

Ready to add the psychological layer.

## Recommended prior learning

The Level 2 Award in Introduction to Financial Trading, or equivalent foundational market knowledge.

GOOD TO KNOW

There is no formal barrier to entry — this is a recommendation, and a device with internet access to reach the Learning Management System is all that's required.

# The four moments that decide a trading session.

UNIT 1



## Recognise the emotion in real time

Catch fear, greed and frustration before they become a decision.

UNIT 2



## See the biases behind the crowd

Cognitive bias, loss aversion and herd behaviour, in your trades and the market's.

UNIT 3



## Prepare your mind like a professional

Visualisation and self-talk, used deliberately before a session.

UNIT 4



## Manage the plan, not just the P&L

Set realistic goals and catch the pitfalls of cutting winners early or holding losers too long.

# The numbers behind the programme.

A focused, practitioner-led qualification: 4 units, 8 credits, delivered fully online at Level 3.

| 4 | 8 | 3 | 6–10 |
|---|---|---|---|
| UNITS | CREDITS | LEVEL | WEEKS TYPICAL |

## THE FOUR UNITS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Trading Emotions — Recognition and Control | 2 credits |
| 2 | Market Psychology and Behavioural Finance | 2 credits |
| 3 | Visualisation, Self-Talk and Mental Performance | 2 credits |
| 4 | Trade Execution, Goal Setting and P&L Management | 2 credits |

| | |
|---|---|
| QUALIFICATION | ISFT Award in Introduction to Behavioural Psychology in Trading |
| OCN LONDON COURSE CODE | 1131238 |
| CENTRE | Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT), Centre ID 160472 |
| ACCREDITATION / REVIEW | Accredited 13/08/2026 · Reviewed 13/08/2027 |

# Learn online, at your own pace.

Delivered fully online and self-paced through Derivion Academy. There is no fixed timetable: learners typically finish within 6 to 10 weeks.

01

### Study

Video instruction and written materials.

02

### Reflect

Case studies of emotionally-driven trading decisions.

03

### Assess

An online MCQ for each unit.

04

### Journal

A structured reflective journal, assessed by the Head Educator.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Computer, laptop, tablet or smartphone
- An internet connection to the LMS
- Willingness to reflect honestly on your own trading

# Four units, one steadier mind.

1 — 2 — 3 — 4

EB1/3/LR/028

## Trading Emotions — Recognition and Control

2 credits

EB1/3/LR/029

## Market Psychology and Behavioural Finance

2 credits

EB1/3/LR/030

## Visualisation, Self-Talk and Mental Performance

2 credits

EB1/3/LR/031

## Trade Execution, Goal Setting and P&L Management

2 credits

# Trading Emotions — Recognition and Control

01

*“The trade was never the problem. The reaction to it was.”*

2 credits

## Emotional responses that affect trading

- Identify common emotional responses experienced by traders
- Explain how at least three emotional responses can lead to poor trading decisions

## Recognising and managing emotions

- Describe practical techniques for recognising an emotional state while trading
- Explain how a structured process can reduce emotionally-driven decision-making

## INDICATIVE CONTENT

- Common trading emotions and triggers
- Case studies of emotionally-driven losses
- Recognition techniques
- Structured decision processes

# Market Psychology and Behavioural Finance

02

*"A bubble is just a bias, shared by enough people."*

2 credits

## Key concepts in behavioural finance

- Explain the concept of cognitive bias and its relevance to trading decisions
- Describe common biases including confirmation bias, loss aversion, and herd behaviour

## Market psychology and collective behaviour

- Explain how herd behaviour can contribute to market trends, bubbles, or crashes
- Identify behavioural finance concepts evident in a given historical market event

## INDICATIVE CONTENT

Confirmation bias, loss aversion, herd behaviour

Behavioural finance theory

Historical case studies of market psychology

# Visualisation, Self-Talk and Mental Performance

03

*“Professionals rehearse the session before the market opens.”*

2 credits

## Mental performance techniques

- Explain the principle of visualisation as a mental performance technique
- Describe how self-talk can influence trading confidence and discipline

## Applying techniques to a scenario

- Construct an example of constructive self-talk for a stated trading scenario
- Evaluate how a mental performance technique could be used to prepare for a trading session

## INDICATIVE CONTENT

- Visualisation techniques
- Constructive vs destructive self-talk
- Mental preparation routines of professional traders

# Trade Execution, Goal Setting and P&L Management

04

2 credits

*“Cutting winners early and holding losers long both come from the same place.”*

## Trade execution and goal setting

- Explain how unclear or unrealistic goals can negatively affect trading behaviour
- Describe principles of effective goal setting applied to a trading context

## The psychology of profit and loss

- Explain common psychological pitfalls in managing profit and loss, e.g. cutting winners early, holding losers too long
- Evaluate own emotional responses and trading behaviours through a structured reflective journal

## INDICATIVE CONTENT

- Goal-setting principles for traders
- Psychological pitfalls in P&L management
- Structured reflective journalling

# Look back at the trade. Honestly.

Unit 4 ends with a structured reflective journal: evaluate your own emotional responses and trading behaviours over the course of the unit.

## 1,000–1,200

words, structured reflective journal

Assessed by the Head Educator against a published marking brief.

### REFLECTIVE JOURNAL

A structured, honest look back

**Emotional responses**

What you felt, and when, during trading

**Goals and execution**

How goal-setting shaped your decisions

**P&L pitfalls**

Cutting winners early, holding losers long

# How you're assessed.

Each unit closes with an online MCQ, auto-marked on the LMS. Unit 4 adds a structured reflective journal.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| EB1/3/LR/028 | Trading Emotions — Recognition and Control | MCQ |
| EB1/3/LR/029 | Market Psychology and Behavioural Finance | MCQ |
| EB1/3/LR/030 | Visualisation, Self-Talk and Mental Performance | MCQ |
| EB1/3/LR/031 | Trade Execution, Goal Setting and P&L Management | MCQ + journal |

*25 questions · 50 minutes · 70% pass mark on every MCQ · journal is 1,000–1,200 words*

### MCQ: recognition level

Where criteria say explain, describe or compare, you select the correct answer from plausible alternatives.

### Journal: application

Criteria that ask you to construct or evaluate are assessed through the Unit 4 reflective journal.

# Standards you can rely on.

Assessment is quality-assured at every stage, and the qualification is reviewed every year.

### 1 Set

Activities are set internally by tutor/assessors so learners can meet the learning outcomes and assessment criteria.

### 2 Moderated

Assessed evidence is internally moderated at the centre, unless it is computer-assessed.

### 3 Externally verified

An OCN London External Quality Assurer moderates externally.

### 4 Reviewed every year

By the Head Educator, informed by learner feedback, IQA review and OCN London feedback.

# Your next step.

On completion, learners may progress to the Introduction to Risk Management Award or the Introduction to Technical Analysis in Trading Certificate.

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